

The SEO Quick-Win Checklist

Five fixes you can make today - free tools only, about one hour total. Extracted from the 29-point technical audit in The Google Search Ranking Playbook.

1

Check that Google can actually see you

5 MINUTES - INDEXATION

Open Google Search Console (free) and look at the Pages report. Every important page should be indexed.

If an important page says 'Crawled - currently not indexed' or 'Excluded by noindex tag', that page is invisible to search - no tactic will fix rankings until this does.

Submit (or re-submit) your sitemap under Sitemaps, and request indexing for any fixed money page via URL Inspection.

Why this first: indexation problems silently block everything else. The full playbook covers this in Chapter 17.

2

Compress your three biggest images

10 MINUTES - CORE WEB VITALS

Open your homepage and top pages on a phone. Note the three largest images (usually heroes and banners).

Export them as WebP or quality-70 JPEG at real display size, and re-upload. WordPress: a free plugin like Smush or ShortPixel does this in bulk.

Add loading='lazy' to every image below the first screen.

Why it works: image weight is the most common cause of a failed Largest Contentful Paint - and fast pages are measurably more likely to be cited by AI Overviews. Chapter 8.

3

Add basic structured data to your top 3 pages

10 MINUTES - SCHEMA

Paste this JSON-LD into the head of each key article, filling in your own values:

```
{ "@context": "https://schema.org", "@type": "Article", "headline": "Your title", "datePublished": "2026-01-01", "dateModified": "2026-09-01", "author": { "@type": "Person", "name": "Your Name" } }
```

Validate with Google's Rich Results Test (free), then submit the URL for re-indexing.

Why it works: schema makes your page unambiguous to machines - including the AI features that quote and cite content. Chapter 21.

4

Mine your Search Console queries for content gaps**15 MINUTES - CONTENT**

In Search Console, open Performance and set the filter to queries where your average position is 8-30.

You are visible for these searches but not winning them. For each: does your page genuinely answer that query, in the format the searcher wants?

Where it does not, add a section that does - a direct answer under a question-shaped heading. One page per gap, not a new thin page per keyword.

Why it works: the cheapest rankings you will ever win are the ones Google already shows you for. Chapter 16.

5

Point your strongest pages at your weakest important ones**10 MINUTES - INTERNAL LINKS**

Open your analytics or Search Console and note your 3 highest-traffic pages.

From each, add one contextual link - descriptive anchor text, not 'click here' - to a page you want to rank that currently gets little traffic.

Three to five such links, built naturally into sentences, is enough to move a page.

Why it works: internal links are the one link source you fully control, and they tell Google which pages you consider important. Chapter 12.

This checklist is the first 1% of the system.

The Google Search Ranking Playbook is the other 99%: 100 pages and 32 chapters on how Google actually ranks pages - built from Google's own documentation and the U.S. v. Google trial record - plus a 30-task, 12-month roadmap, a 29-point technical audit, and 10 niche playbooks, all importable into Notion, Sheets, or Excel in five minutes.

Get the complete system at searchrankpro.web.app - instant download, lifetime updates.